

3. SMSSecure doesn't rely on the Internet. Your conversation solely depends on the encrypted messages you send from your device; so all your chats are reliable.
4. SMSSecure employs AES 256 bit encryption; so you have industrial standard encryption on your phone.
5. The app will automatically detect if the recipient is using SMSSecure, and encourage the starting of an encrypted session with the other party.

TinFoil for Facebook

Did you know that your official Facebook app possesses many controls over your device, so that your online activities could be monitored by someone? If you didn't know that, then you need to wake up!

As common users, we never tend to take a closer look at the permissions that our apps request our device. These are concealed in a more generic manner now, so you do not get a clear picture about the permissions you are handing over to that app. The official Facebook app is no exception.

Monitoring your device is the easiest way to keep tabs on you. And most of us use Facebook extensively in our day-to-day lives, sharing information about our private lives. So you must realise that your privacy could be easily compromised.

TinFoil for Facebook uses a wrapper around the mobile site of Facebook, and thereby provides a sandbox for the Facebook cookies, which are separated from the normal browsing cookies. This ensures that your browsing information will be safely kept inside, instead of being leaked via other means.

TinFoil for Facebook also provides more privacy by ensuring that all other links you visit inside Facebook are opened within the app instead of being opened in an external browser.

This app can track your location by enabling the 'Allow Check-ins' under 'Preferences'. But you can disable this feature anytime you want. Also, you can kill this app once you're done browsing, so that you don't have to worry whether it is running in the background or syncing your data without your knowledge.

FBReader

FBReader or Favourite Book Reader is an ad-free, highly customisable e-book reader for Android, with support for all popular book formats. It has some online catalogues where you can download public domain books free of cost. You can add your own online catalogues too.

You can use the FBReader book network as your personal online library. By using this feature you can upload the books to Google Drive and download those books anytime, anywhere you want.

FBReader allows you to tweak its features in many ways such as installing your own fonts, and changing the animations while turning the pages, adding plugins, selecting from various colour schemes for the UI, and much more.

Amaze File Manager

Amaze File Manager has a beautiful, sleek interface packed with lots of features for the normal user. The concealed side panel has various options for quicker navigation.

I recommend that you start tweaking the 'Settings' menu, since it offers more flexibility for users to customise the app according to their own preferences, with regard to themes, colour and other appearance aspects.

It also has another interesting feature, 'App Manager', which manages all your system and user installed apps. By clicking on an app, you can back it up without any additional backup software. You can share the app with other users, open the app page on F-Droid, and uninstall the app. You can do all this without leaving the Amaze File Manager.

You can also unlock the power user features by enabling the 'Root Explorer' option in the settings menu. But to use this option, you have to make sure that your phone is rooted.

K-9 Mail

K-9 Mail is one of the popular email clients for Android. It can support multiple accounts, which can be customised according to your preferences. One of the important features of K-9 Mail is its ability to encrypt your mail and files using Android Privacy Guard (APG).

K-9 Mail can connect to Web servers using all popular protocols such as POP3, IMAP and WebDAV. It offers lots of features to an Android user, some of which are not provided by the stock Android email clients. These include:

1. Per account notification
2. Emoji support
3. Push IMAP support
4. The ability to attach almost any type of file on SD card
5. Personalised signatures

My Expenses

My Expenses is a personal finance manager for your Android phone. It has a very sleek interface which makes the app easier to use. The concealed side panel displays your accounts. Currently it can support up to five accounts with transfers.

You can have some preselected categories for your transaction so that you can keep the transactions in an organised way, based on the day, week, month, year, etc. Import and export of your transactions using the QIF or CSV data formats can be done.

You can also set up password protection for entering data in the main app or its widgets. 

By: Magimai Prakash

The author has completed a B.E in computer science. As he is deeply interested in Linux, he spends most of his leisure time exploring open source.